



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt,
Gnóthaí Baile agus Imirce
Department of Justice,
Home Affairs and Migration

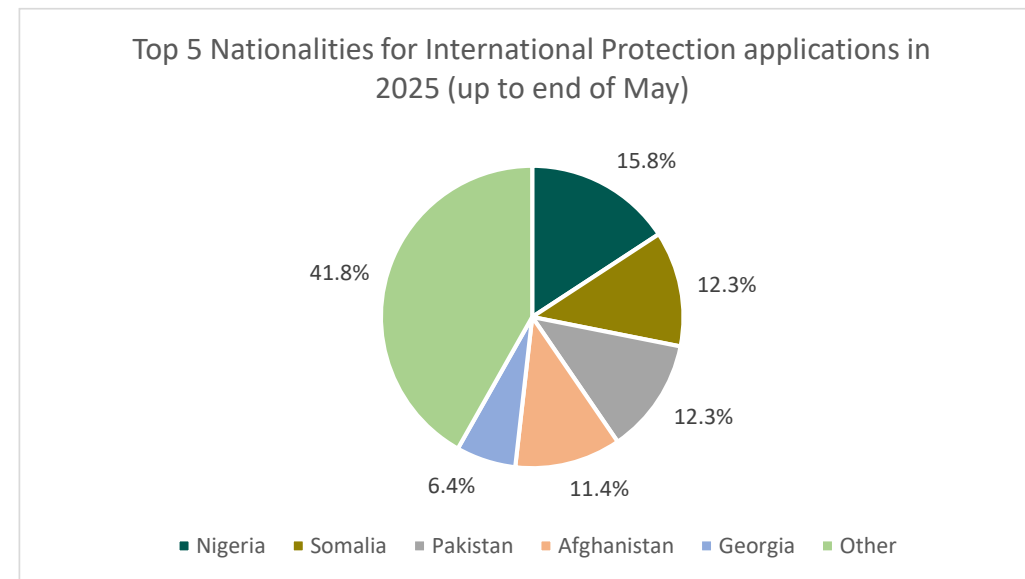
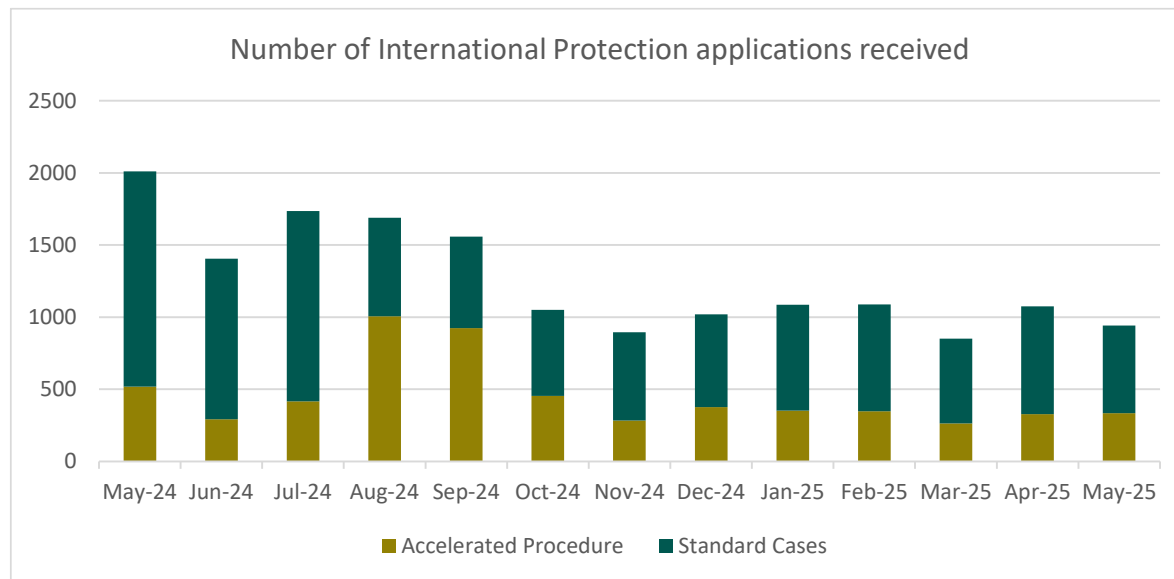
International Protection: May 2025

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 05th June 2025. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for May 2025:

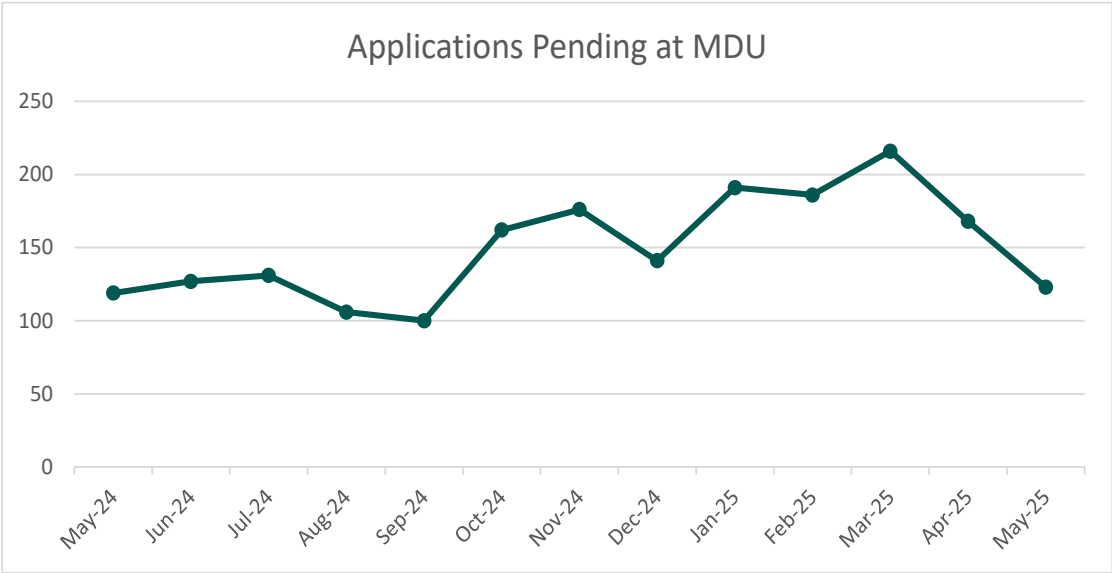
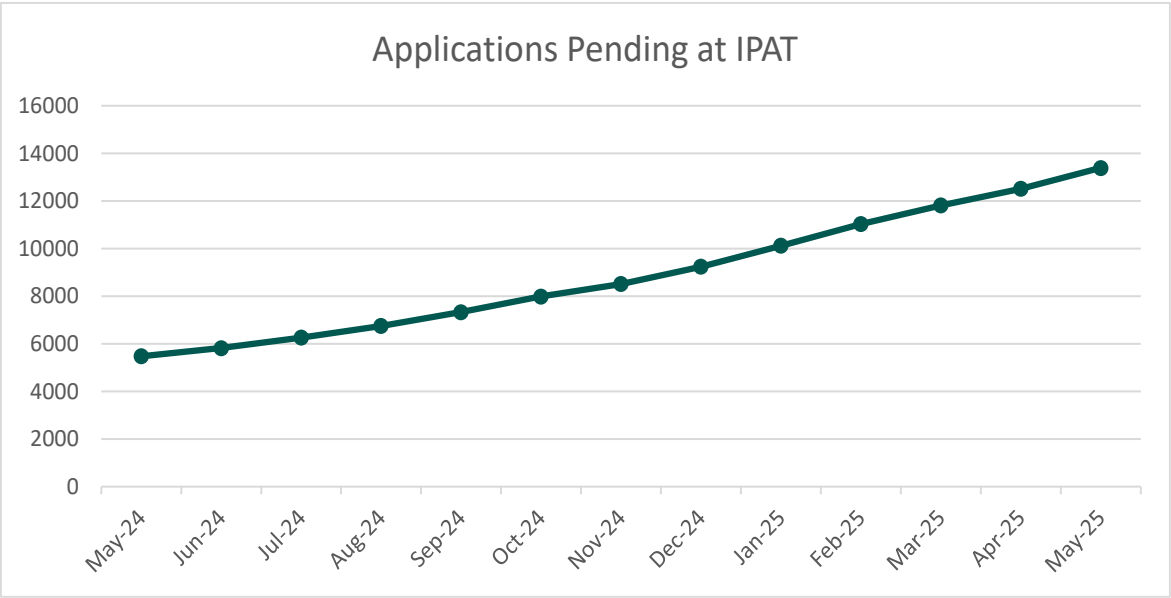
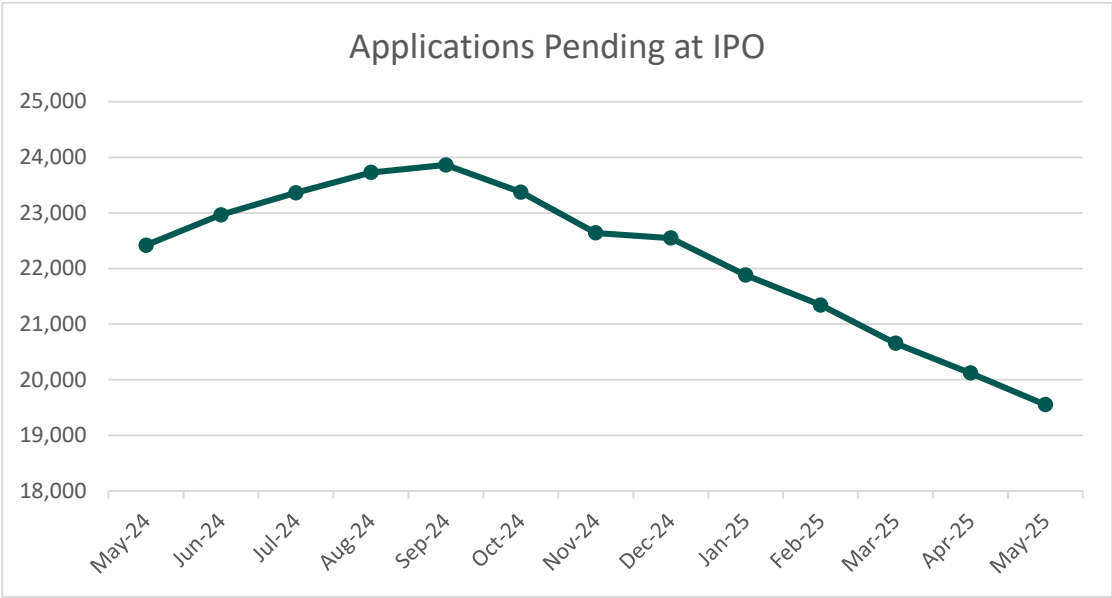
- Compared to last year, the number of asylum applications has dropped significantly. In May 2025 there were 941 applications compared to 2,010 in May 2024. So far this year, through May, the total number of applications has dropped from 9,194 down to 5,039, a reduction of 45%
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (795 applications), Somalia (622), Pakistan (621), Afghanistan (572) and Georgia (322)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the end of September 2024, when it stood at 23,863. As of May this year, there were 19,552 applications pending
- Compared to last year, there has been an increase in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In May 2025, 1,488 cases were closed off compared to 1,193 in May 2024
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases is still trending slightly downwards. In May 2025, the median processing time to determination was 71 weeks (compared to 81.5 weeks in November 2024 and 74 weeks in February 2025)
- The number of staff in the IPO has reduced slightly, 601 at the end of May 2025
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in May 2025 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 51% of decisions were refusals, 3% permission to remain, and 46% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



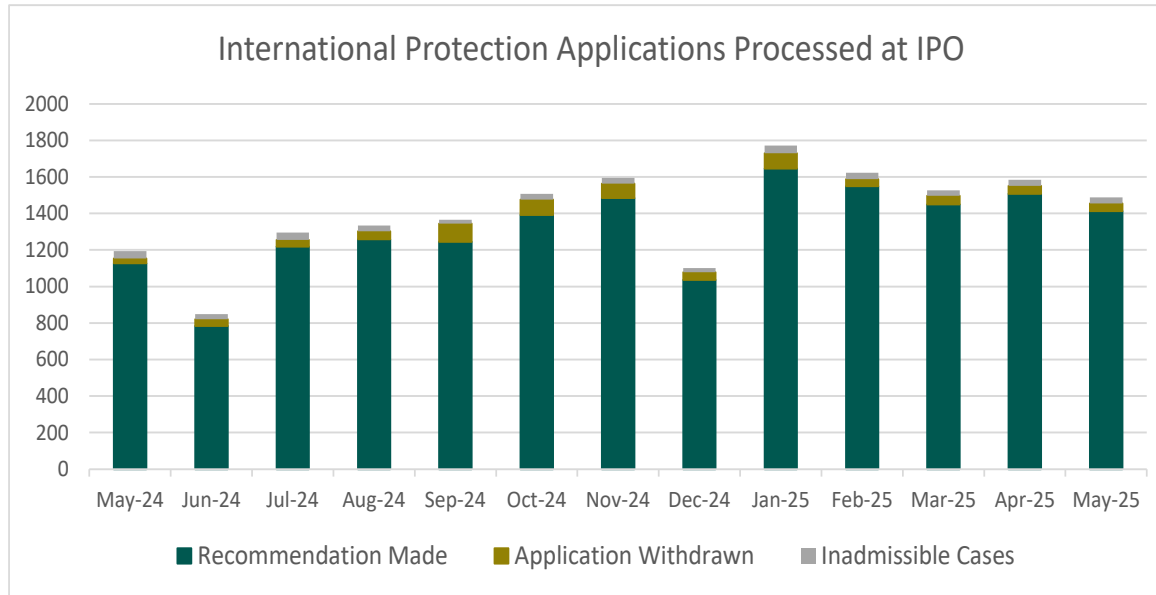
- In May there were 941 applications received for asylum. This is down from 2,010 last May
- The total number of applications in May 2025 that fell under accelerated procedure was 333 (which represents 35% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (795 applications), Somalia (622), Pakistan (621), Afghanistan (572) and Georgia (322)

Pending International Protection Applications

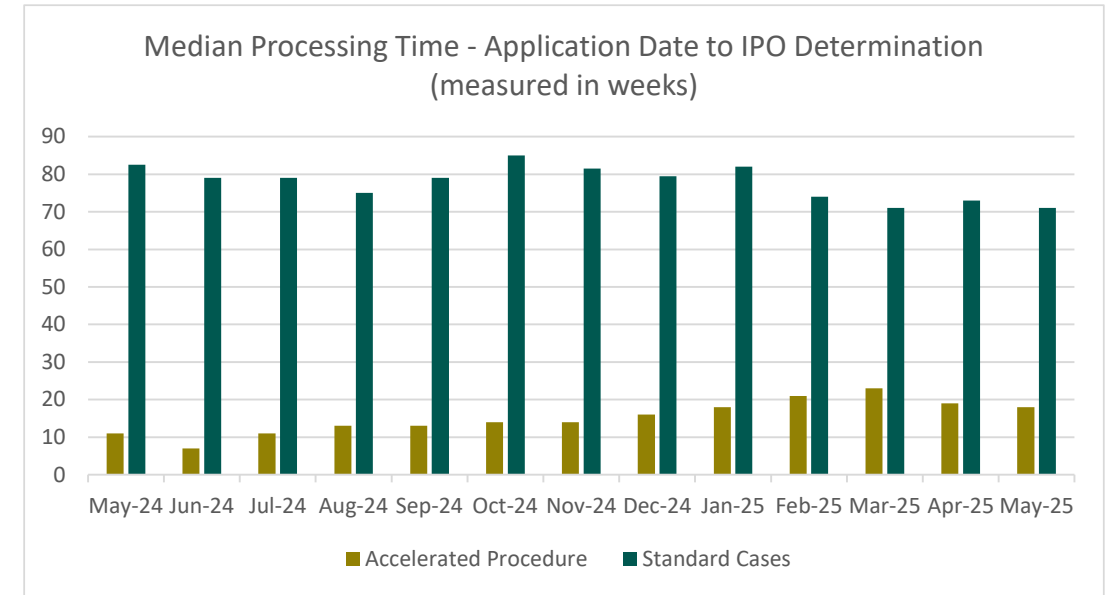


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 19,552. The numbers have begun to reduce since the end of September 2024
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In May 2025, there were 13,393 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of May 2025 is 123

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

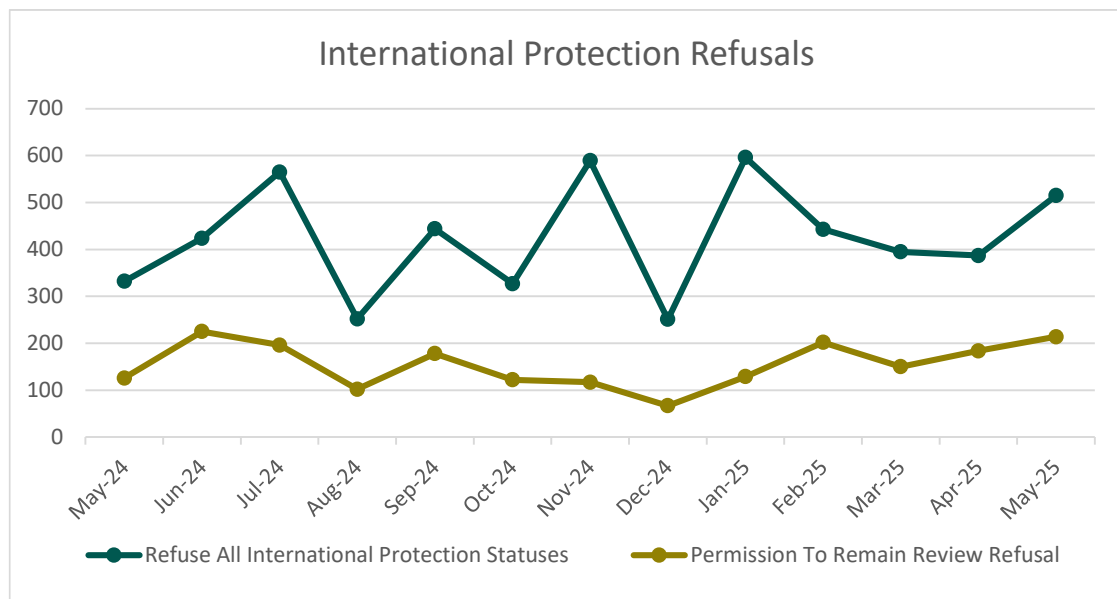
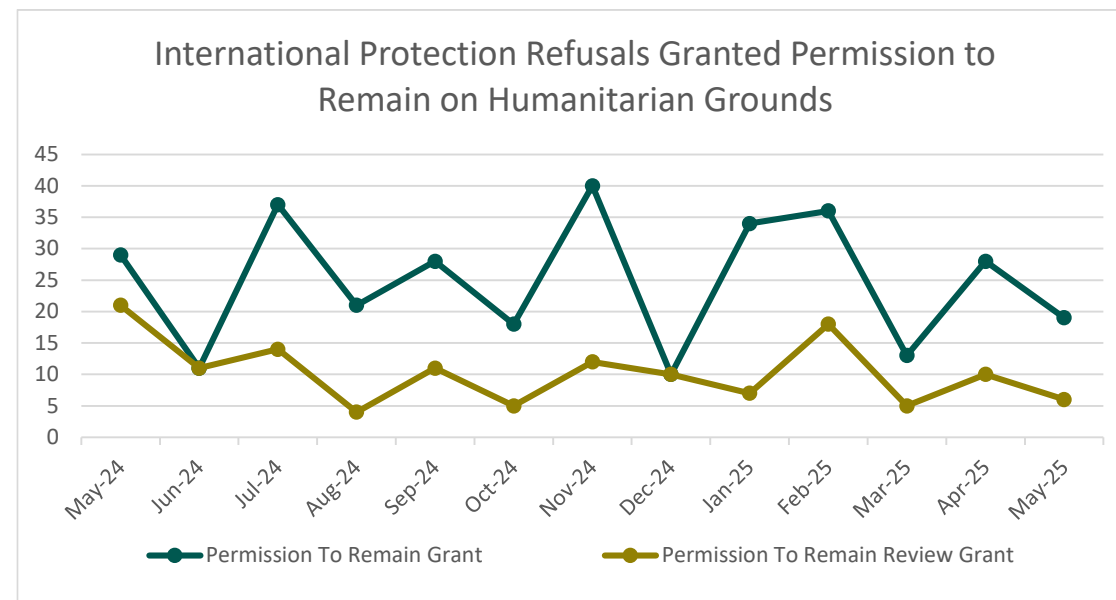
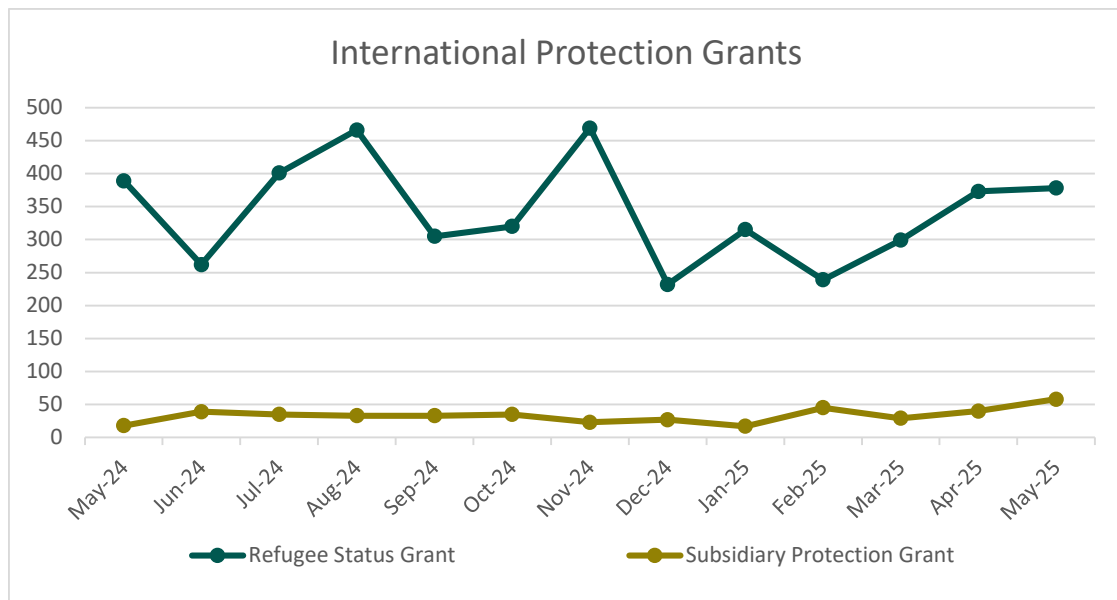


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In May 2025, 1,488 cases were closed off. This is down from 1,527 in March and 1,584 in April
- 2025 YTD applications processed were 7,994 (a 57.5% increase on 5,077 applications processed for 2024 YTD)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been slowly decreasing since October 2024 for Standard Cases and has decreased for cases under the Accelerated Procedure between March and May 2025
- In May 2025, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 71 weeks (the same as for March and down from 73 weeks for April)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 18 weeks in May 2025, down from 23 weeks in March and 19 weeks in April

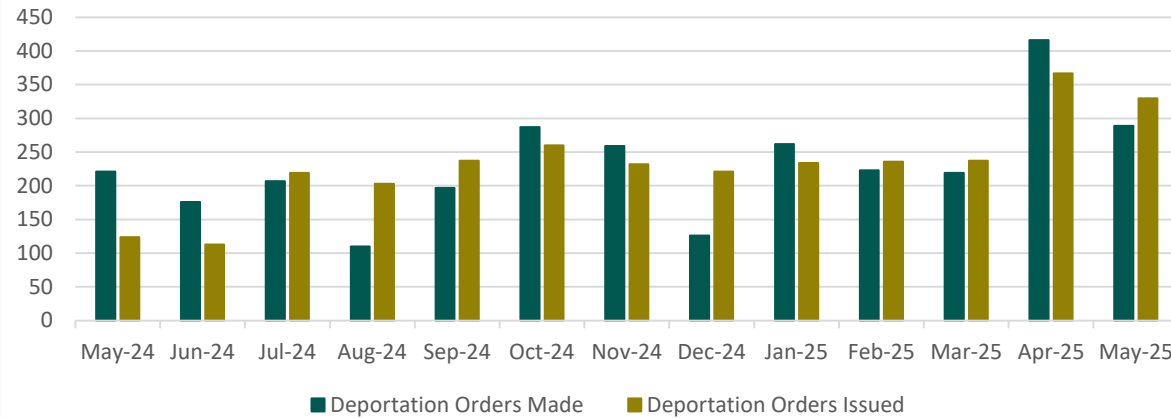
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In May 2025, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 378 were given refugee status grant and 58 subsidiary protection grant (436 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 19 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 6 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 515 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 214 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall, for May 2025, 51% of decisions were refusals, 3% permission to remain, and 46% were international protection grants

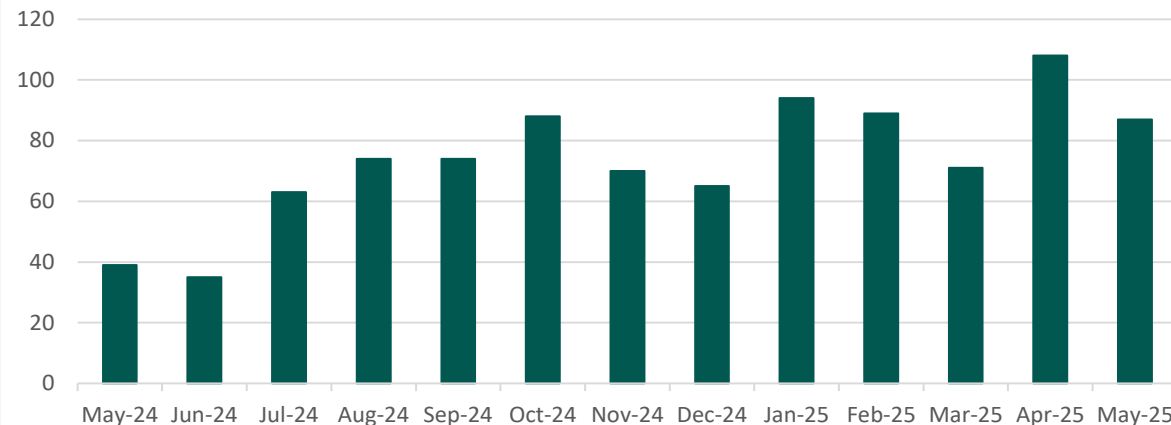
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

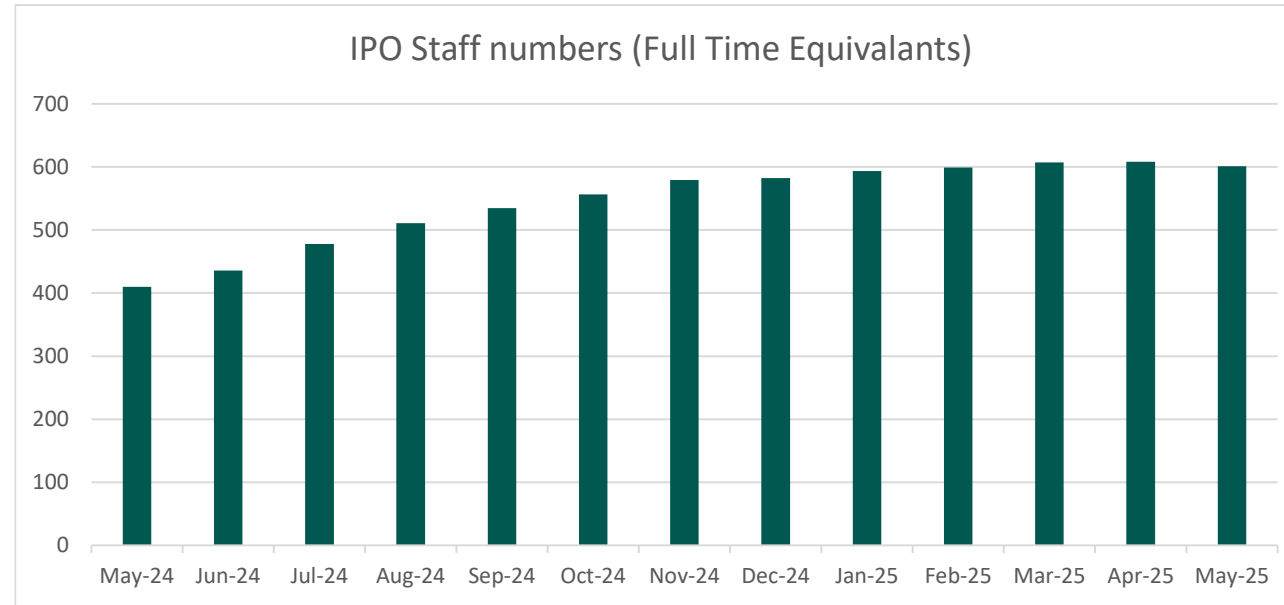


- For May 2025 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 289 and the number of deportation orders issued was 330. For April, the figures were 416 and 367, and for March, it was 219 and 237, respectively
- For May 2025 the number of removals was 87

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has started levelling off
- In May 2024 there were 410 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 579 in November 2024 and 599 in February 2025
- At the end of May 2025, the IPO had 601 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

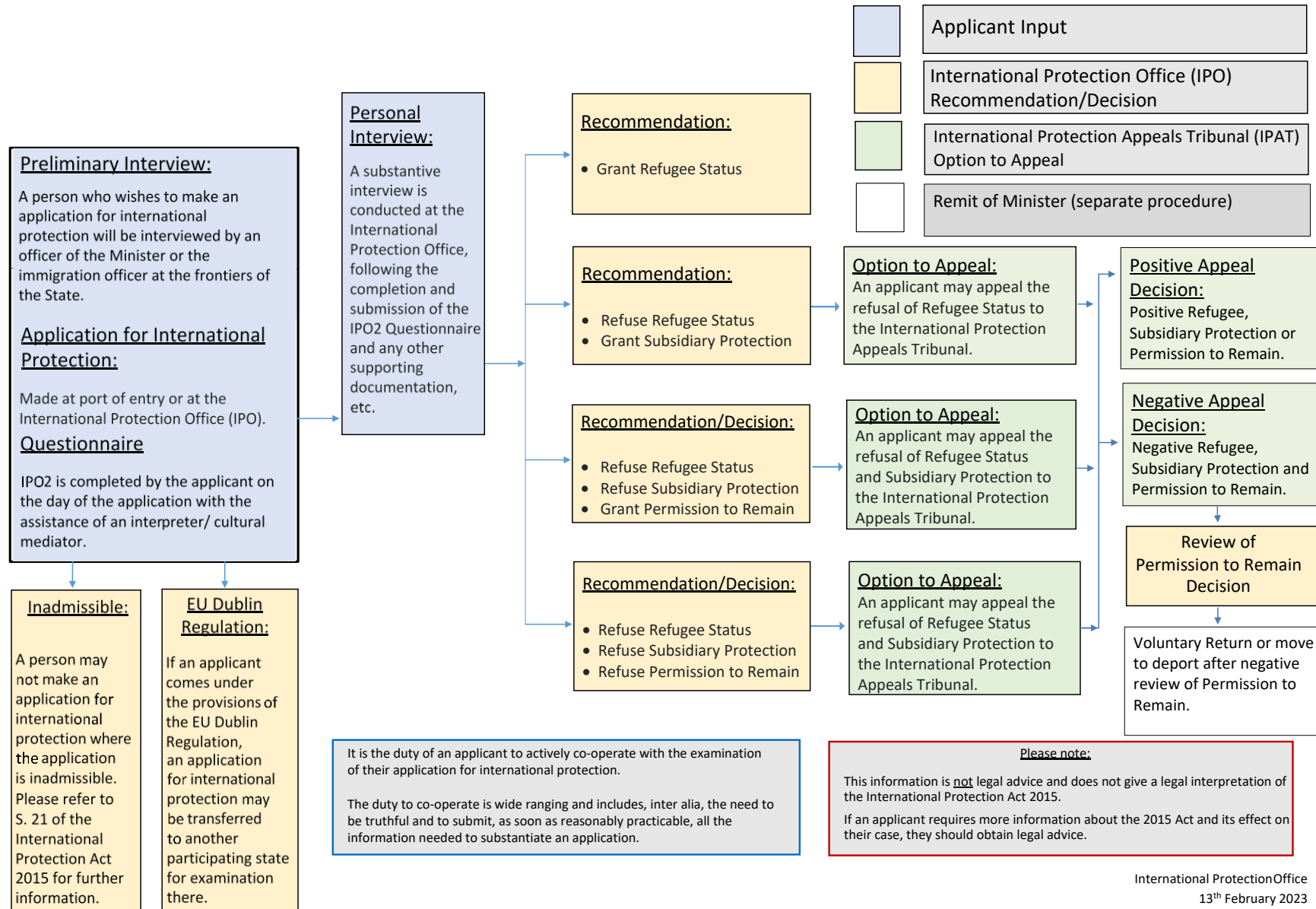
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
Accelerated Procedure	518	292	417	1005	923	453	282	377	351	347	264	327	333
Standard Cases	1492	1112	1318	685	636	597	614	643	734	742	586	747	608

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2025 to date	Applications	%
Nigeria	795	15.8%
Somalia	622	12.3%
Pakistan	621	12.3%
Afghanistan	572	11.4%
Georgia	322	6.4%
Other	2107	41.8%
Total	5039	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
IP Pending	22419	22965	23360	23727	23863	23373	22641	22548	21882	21343	20655	20122	19551
Leg Pending	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
IPAT Pending	5478	5821	6257	6748	7331	7990	8513	9243	10125	11031	11819	12517	13393

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
MDU Pending	119	127	131	106	100	162	176	141	191	186	216	168	123

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
Recommendation Made	1128	784	1219	1259	1244	1392	1484	1036	1646	1550	1449	1508	1413
Application Withdrawn	25	36	36	44	101	83	80	43	84	38	47	43	41
Inadmissible Cases	40	29	40	31	21	33	30	22	42	35	31	33	34

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
Accelerated Procedure	11	7	11	13	13	14	14	16	18	21	23	19	18
Standard Cases	82.5	79	79	75	79	85	81.5	79.5	82	74	71	73	71

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
Refugee Status Grant	389	262	401	466	305	320	469	232	315	239	299	373	378
Subsidiary Protection Grant	18	39	35	33	33	35	23	27	17	45	29	40	58
Permission To Remain Grant	29	11	37	21	28	18	40	10	34	36	13	28	19
Permission To Remain Review Grant	21	11	14	4	11	5	12	10	7	18	5	10	6

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	332	424	565	252	444	327	589	251	596	443	395	387	515
Permission To Remain Review Refusal	126	225	196	102	178	122	117	67	129	202	150	184	214

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
Deportation Orders Made	221	176	207	110	197	287	259	126	262	223	219	416	289
Deportation Orders Issued	124	113	219	203	237	260	232	221	234	236	237	367	330

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
Enforcements/Returns*	39	35	63	74	74	88	70	65	94	89	71	108	87

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25
IPO Staffing Level	409.7	435.7	477.7	510.7	534.3	556.3	579.1	582.1	593.4	598.8	607	608	601